Parsons problems

Programming · Level 3 · Lesson 2



Today we will

- Explain what a Parsons problem is and why it works.
- Design one with good distractors and indentation.
- Run it on paper strips, with no devices.

Remember

- Exactly one correct order.
- Indentation is part of the answer.
- Distractors come from real misconceptions.

Strips on the desk

1. Warm-up (5 min): Order three lines of a recipe.
2. Teach (5 min): A Parsons problem on the board.
3. Solve (15 min): Pairs order and indent program strips.
4. Explain (10 min): Pairs explain their order; reveal the distractor.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Run it on the phone. Exit ticket.

Prepare strip sets in envelopes and reuse them with every class. Darsi's worksheets print this lesson's Parsons problems ready to cut.

Let’s discuss

1. Why must a Parsons problem have exactly one correct order?
2. Which distractor worked best, and why?
3. When would you move pupils from Parsons to writing code?

Exit ticket

- Write one distractor for a loop that counts to 10, and the misconception behind it.